

Kant — MCQ Questions

Philosophy Optional | Paper I | Western Philosophy | Topic 04

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MCQ QUESTION INDEX

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MCQ 1. What "transcendental" means in Kant

Consider the following statements about Kant's use of the terms *transcendental* and *transcendent*.

1. A transcendental enquiry concerns the a priori conditions under which objects can be given to us.
2. A transcendent employment of the categories carries them beyond all possible experience.
3. Kant's own philosophy is transcendent, and the errors he diagnoses are transcendental.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 and 3 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

MCQ 2. What Hume actually did to Kant, and where Kant says it

Which one of the following statements about Hume's role in the genesis of the critical philosophy is **accurate**?

- A. Kant says in the *Critique of Pure Reason* that Hume awoke him from his dogmatic slumber.
- B. Kant rejects Hume's analysis of experience and shows that necessary connexion is perceived after all.
- C. Kant treats Hume as a dogmatist whose confidence in reason had to be curbed by criticism.
- D. Kant says in the *Prolegomena* that the recollection of Hume interrupted his dogmatic slumber.

MCQ 3. The analytic/synthetic distinction and the empty cell

Which one of the following is **correct** about Kant's cross-classification of judgements?

- A. Analytic a posteriori judgements cannot exist, since containment makes experience idle.
- B. Synthetic a priori judgements are precisely those whose denial is self-contradictory.
- C. Analytic judgements are ampliative, since they make explicit what was only implicit.
- D. Synthetic a posteriori judgements are strictly universal because they generalise over cases.

MCQ 4. Kant's two marks of a priori cognition

According to Kant at B3–4, which pair of features marks a cognition as a priori?

- A. Clarity and distinctness of ideas

- B. Simplicity and immediate self-evidence
- C. Necessity and strict universality
- D. Certainty and psychological indubitability

MCQ 5. Why " $7 + 5 = 12$ " is synthetic

Kant argues that " $7 + 5 = 12$ " is a synthetic judgement principally because

- A. the concept of the sum of seven and five contains only their union and not twelve
- B. the judgement is verified by counting objects and is therefore drawn from experience
- C. arithmetical propositions can be denied without contradiction and might have been false
- D. the equality sign asserts a real relation between two independently existing quantities

MCQ 6. The exact content of the change of standpoint

Which one of the following states Kant's hypothesis at Bxvi–xviii **without distortion**?

- A. Things in themselves conform to the categories of the human understanding.
- B. Objects, as objects of possible experience, conform to our a priori forms.
- C. The human mind creates the objects it perceives entirely out of its own resources.
- D. Cognition must conform to objects, which is why a priori knowledge is impossible.

MCQ 7. The 2023 printed sentence and Kant's own formulation

The 2023 Paper I question prints: "Precepts without concepts are blind and concepts without precepts are empty." Which one of the following is the **correct** handling of this line?

- A. Silently replace the printed line with Kant's own formulation and answer from that.
- B. Treat the printed line as Kant's own exact words, since it appears in an official paper.
- C. Refuse to answer this part at all, since the quoted sentence misrepresents the *Critique*.
- D. Quote the paper as printed, then give Kant's A51/B75 wording and note the substitution.

MCQ 8. Which arguments of the metaphysical exposition do which job

In the metaphysical exposition of space, which grouping correctly matches the arguments to what they establish?

- A. Arguments 1 and 3 establish apriority; arguments 2 and 4 establish intuitivity.
- B. All four arguments establish apriority, and intuitivity is established separately.
- C. Arguments 1 and 2 establish apriority; arguments 3 and 4 establish intuitivity.
- D. Arguments 2 and 3 establish apriority; arguments 1 and 4 establish intuitivity.

MCQ 9. The transcendental exposition and its historical qualification

Which one of the following most accurately states the position of Kant's transcendental exposition of space after the rise of non-Euclidean geometry?

- A. Non-Euclidean geometry refutes the claim that space is the a priori form of outer sense.
- B. Non-Euclidean geometry leaves the transcendental exposition of space entirely unaffected.
- C. Non-Euclidean geometry shows that space is after all a discursive concept, not an intuition.
- D. Non-Euclidean geometry weakens the argument from geometry, not the metaphysical exposition.

MCQ 10. Transcendental ideality with empirical reality

Match Kant's two claims about space with what each of them blocks.

1. Transcendental ideality — 2. Empirical reality

I. It blocks the charge that space is an illusion or a private fancy. II. It blocks both Newton's self-subsistent containers and Leibniz's confused relations among things in themselves.

Which of the following is the correct matching, and what follows?

- A. 1–II, 2–I, and the two claims must always be stated together
- B. 1–I, 2–II, and the two claims must always be stated together
- C. 1–II, 2–I, and the second claim is a later concession
- D. 1–I, 2–II, and the first claim alone captures transcendental idealism

MCQ 11. The derivation of the categories

Consider the following statements about Kant's metaphysical deduction.

- 1. The categories are derived from the logical functions of judgement, on the premise that the understanding is a faculty of judging.
- 2. The hypothetical form of judgement yields the category of causality and dependence.
- 3. The third category in each group is an entirely independent concept unrelated to the first two.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 and 2 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

MCQ 12. Metaphysical deduction versus transcendental deduction

Which one of the following correctly distinguishes the two deductions?

- A. The metaphysical deduction argues from apperception; the transcendental deduction argues from the table of judgements.
- B. The metaphysical deduction identifies the categories; the transcendental deduction justifies their application.
- C. The metaphysical deduction concerns space and time; the transcendental deduction concerns the categories.
- D. The metaphysical deduction is found only in the A edition; the transcendental deduction only in the B edition.

MCQ 13. What the transcendental unity of apperception is

Which one of the following best states Kant's doctrine of apperception?

- A. It is the standing possibility that the "I think" accompany all my representations.
- B. It is the empirical consciousness of oneself obtained by careful inner observation.
- C. It is the simple, permanent soul-substance that the act of thinking is said to reveal.
- D. It is the bundle of perceptions that Hume claimed to discover by careful introspection.

MCQ 14. "Understanding makes Nature"

Which one of the following is **not** part of what Kant means by the dictum that the understanding makes nature?

- A. Categories supply the a priori rules under which a manifold can count as objective nature.
- B. Nature, formally considered, is the law-governed unity of appearances.
- C. Sensations alone are unordered and must be synthesised to yield objects.
- D. The understanding produces the particular empirical laws that science discovers.

MCQ 15. Schema and image

Which one of the following correctly states Kant's distinction between a schema and an image?

- A. The schema is a faint mental image, while the image itself is a vivid one.
- B. The schema is a rule of construction, while the image is a particular product.
- C. The schema belongs to sensibility, while the image belongs to the understanding.
- D. The schema is empirical, while the image is pure and given wholly a priori.

MCQ 16. Why time and not space supplies the schemata

Kant holds that the mediating schemata must be determinations of time rather than of space because

- A. time is more fundamental than space in the order of Kant's own exposition
- B. spatial relations are less exact and less measurable than temporal relations
- C. time is the form of inner sense and therefore present in every representation
- D. space is empirically real whereas time is transcendently ideal in Kant's system

MCQ 17. The three Analogies

Match each Analogy of Experience with the mode of time it determines and the proxy it supplies.

1. First Analogy — 2. Second Analogy — 3. Third Analogy

I. Succession, secured by a causal rule. II. Simultaneity, secured by thoroughgoing reciprocity. III. Duration, secured by a persisting substratum.

Which of the following is the correct matching?

- A. 1–I, 2–II, 3–III
- B. 1–II, 2–III, 3–I
- C. 1–III, 2–I, 3–II
- D. 1–I, 2–III, 3–II

MCQ 18. The house and the ship

In the Second Analogy, what exactly does the contrast between viewing a house and watching a ship drift downstream establish?

- A. That mere succession of perceptions cannot constitute perception of an objective succession

- B. That the perception of a house is instantaneous while the perception of a ship is extended in time
- C. That objective events are perceived more vividly than merely subjective sequences of perception
- D. That the imagination reverses the order of perceptions whenever the object perceived is at rest

MCQ 19. Strawson's objection and the correct adjudication

Which one of the following states the defensible verdict on Kant's Second Analogy against Hume?

- A. Kant proves the particular causal laws that Hume had declared to be unknowable.
- B. Kant secures entitlement to the concept of cause but leaves causal laws empirical.
- C. Kant fails entirely, since Strawson shows the whole argument to be a non-sequitur.
- D. Kant relocates necessity into the objects, where Hume had simply failed to find it.

MCQ 20. The negative noumenon

Which one of the following correctly describes Kant's noumenon in the negative sense?

- A. An object of a non-sensible intellectual intuition available to all finite minds
- B. A hidden object that causes our sensations while itself remaining unobserved
- C. An illusory appearance that empirical criteria eventually expose as deceptive
- D. A limiting concept marking where sensible intuition ceases to yield knowledge

MCQ 21. Regulative and constitutive uses of the Ideas

Consider the following statements about the three Ideas of Reason.

1. The Ideas of soul, world and God correspond to the categorical, hypothetical and disjunctive relations respectively.
2. Used regulatively, the Ideas direct enquiry toward systematic unity and are legitimate.
3. Used constitutively, the Ideas yield theoretical knowledge of a soul-substance, a world-totality and God.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. 3 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1 and 3 only

MCQ 22. The fallacy in the Paralogisms

The Paralogisms of rational psychology are fallacious, according to Kant, because they

- A. rely on premises drawn from experience that turn out on inspection to be false
- B. presuppose the very conclusion about the soul that they had set out to prove
- C. equivocate between the "I" as logical subject and the "I" as a real object
- D. infer a universal conclusion from an insufficient number of observed instances

MCQ 23. When reason enters antinomy, and how the four divide

Which one of the following is **correct** about the Antinomies?

- A. Pure reason enters antinomy when it treats the world-series as an object in itself, and the mathematical antinomies have both sides false.
- B. Pure reason enters antinomy whenever it applies the categories to appearances, and all four antinomies receive exactly the same resolution.
- C. Pure reason enters antinomy because the phenomena–noumena distinction mechanically generates contradiction, and both sides are always true.
- D. Pure reason enters antinomy when the understanding oversteps sensibility, and the dynamical antinomies are resolved by declaring both sides false.

MCQ 24. The dependency among the three God-proofs

Which one of the following correctly states Kant's structural claim about the speculative proofs?

- A. Each of the three proofs stands or falls entirely on the strength of its own evidence.
- B. The ontological proof depends on the cosmological, which depends on the design proof.
- C. The design proof succeeds in establishing an omnipotent creator from the order of nature.
- D. The design proof needs the cosmological, which needs the ontological, so all fail.

MCQ 25. Remedial — what Kant does and does not prove about God

A candidate writes: "Kant's critique of the three proofs establishes that God does not exist." What is wrong with this?

- A. Nothing at all; Kant is an atheist and says so in the second-edition Preface.

- B. Kant establishes that God exists, but only by way of the design argument.
- C. Kant establishes that the very concept of God's existence is self-contradictory.
- D. Kant establishes only that God's existence cannot be demonstrated theoretically.

MCQ 26. Remedial — noumena and Plato's Forms

Why is it wrong to gloss Kant's noumena as equivalent to Plato's Forms?

- A. Plato's Forms are sensible particulars, whereas noumena are universals.
- B. Plato's Forms are knowable by reason, whereas noumena are precisely unknowable.
- C. Plato's Forms are unknowable, whereas noumena are known through pure intuition.
- D. Plato's Forms exist in time, whereas noumena exist outside space only.

MCQ 27. Remedial — the Refutation of Idealism and the "scandal" footnote

Which one of the following is correct about the Refutation of Idealism?

- A. It was added in the second edition of 1787, and the "scandal" remark is a Preface note.
- B. It appeared in the first edition of 1781, and the "scandal" remark is in the Refutation.
- C. It was added in 1787 and is directed principally against Berkeley's own dogmatic idealism.
- D. It appeared in 1781 and proves the existence of things in themselves outside us in space.

MCQ 28. Remedial — the two resolutions must not be merged

A candidate resolves all four antinomies by saying that thesis and antithesis are true in different realms. Where does this go wrong?

- A. It is correct for all four, since every antinomy turns on the phenomena–noumena distinction.
- B. It is wrong for all four, since Kant declares both sides false in every one of the cases.
- C. It is correct only for the dynamical antinomies; the mathematical antinomies have both sides false.
- D. It is correct only for the mathematical antinomies; the dynamical antinomies have both sides false.

MCQ 29. Remedial — substance, alteration and coming-to-be

According to the First Analogy, what is the correct description of change in the world of appearances?

- A. Substances come into being and pass away, and this is what change means.
- B. Change is an illusion, since the persistence of substance excludes all alteration.
- C. Substance persists, and what we call change is the alteration of its states.
- D. Both substance and its states persist, and only our perceptions alter.

MCQ 30. Remedial — the "Copernican" analogy

A candidate writes that Kant's Copernican revolution places the human being at the centre of the universe. What is the correct correction?

- A. Kant does place the knower at the centre, but only within the practical philosophy.
- B. Kant uses the phrase "Copernican revolution" himself at Bxvi, so the reading is authorised.
- C. The analogy concerns the centre of the solar system, which Kant relocates to the mind.
- D. Copernicus displaced the earth from the centre; the analogy is about explanation.

MCQ 31. Remedial — what the Third Antinomy establishes about freedom

Which one of the following states what Kant's resolution of the Third Antinomy actually achieves?

- A. It proves that human beings actually possess transcendental freedom.
- B. It shows that freedom is thinkable without contradiction alongside determinism.
- C. It refutes natural determinism as it operates in the phenomenal world.
- D. It establishes that freedom and natural causality are two names for one relation.

MCQ 32. Remedial — the owner boundary in a God-proof answer

In answering a question on Kant's critique of the proofs for God's existence, which one of the following is the correct treatment of Kant's moral philosophy?

- A. Confine it to the practical postulate of God, and do not expand into ethics.
- B. Devote a full section to the categorical imperative, since morality grounds Kant's theism.
- C. Omit all reference to practical reason, since only theoretical reason is printed in the clause.
- D. Replace the theoretical critique with the moral argument, which Kant regarded as decisive.

MCQ 33. What the Refutation of Idealism establishes

Consider the following statements about Kant's Refutation of Idealism.

1. Determinate awareness of one's inner states in time presupposes relation to something persistent in outer experience.
2. The argument makes inner and outer experience epistemically co-dependent rather than deriving the outer world from an isolated inner certainty.
3. Its conclusion concerns empirically external objects in space, not cognition of things as they are in themselves.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 1, 2 and 3
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1 and 3 only

MCQ 34. The noumenon as a limiting concept

Consider the following statements about a noumenon in Kant's negative sense.

1. It marks the thought of something insofar as it is not an object of sensible intuition.
2. It licenses no determinate knowledge of a hidden object causing appearances, because categories without temporal schemata lack objective employment.
3. Its limiting role blocks the inference that appearances exhaust reality without converting the boundary into a positively known second world.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

MCQ 35. The finite reach of the design proof

A candidate argues that the order of nature proves an infinite necessary creator without borrowing any premise from another proof. Kant's strongest correction is that

- A. finite order supports at most a proportionate architect; reaching a creator and necessary being requires the cosmological step and ultimately the ontological argument

- B. purposive order proves an infinite creator directly, but the proof fails only because existence is known through inner rather than outer sense
- C. the design proof establishes a necessary being, whereas only the move from necessity to personality depends on the cosmological argument
- D. natural order is wholly illusory under transcendental idealism, so no empirical observation may support even a limited theological inference

MCQ 36. Freedom under two standpoints

Consider the following statements about Kant's resolution of the Third Antinomy.

1. As appearance, an action remains subject to natural causality and can be explained within the temporal series.
2. The same agent may be thought under an intelligible standpoint as initiating a series spontaneously, without this becoming theoretical knowledge of freedom.
3. The distinction makes freedom thinkable without dividing the person into two independently existing beings.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1, 2 and 3
- D. 1 and 3 only

MCQ 37. Why transcendental ideality is not private subjectivity

Which one of the following most accurately states Kant's position on space and outer objects?

- A. Space is a private image generated separately by each mind, so agreement about objects requires an inference to noumenal causes.
- B. Space is transcendently ideal as a form of human intuition yet empirically real for every possible outer experience, which secures publicly valid objects of experience.
- C. Space belongs to things in themselves, while only the secondary qualities of objects depend on the subject's mode of intuition.
- D. Outer objects are illusions because transcendental ideality denies that appearances can possess objective empirical reality.

MCQ 38. The temporal schema as a third thing

Consider the following statements about transcendental schematism.

1. A category is purely intellectual, while an empirical intuition is sensible and singular.
2. A schema mediates because it is a rule produced by imagination and a determination of time, the form in which every appearance is given.
3. A schema is not a representative image; it supplies the general procedure by which a category can determine sensible objects.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

MCQ 39. Irreversible succession in the Second Analogy

A viewer may apprehend the parts of a house in either order, but must apprehend a ship's downstream positions in an order constrained by the event. What does Kant infer?

- A. Every temporal succession of perceptions counts as objective because all apprehension occurs in time and follows a determinate order.
- B. Objective succession is distinguished by greater vividness and constancy than the freely reversible sequence.
- C. An objective event requires a rule fixing which state precedes and follows, though the particular causal law remains empirically discoverable.
- D. The ship case proves that the cause and effect are simultaneous, since only simultaneity can prevent reversal of apprehension.

MCQ 40. Crossing Kant's two distinctions

Which one of the following correctly maps Kant's analytic/synthetic and a priori/a posteriori distinctions?

- A. Analytic judgements are a priori; synthetic judgements may be a priori or a posteriori; analytic a posteriori adds no class because conceptual containment already warrants the judgement.
- B. Analytic judgements become a posteriori whenever their concepts were learned from experience, while every synthetic judgement is necessarily a priori.
- C. Analytic and a priori are interchangeable, as are synthetic and a posteriori, so crossing the distinctions still yields only two genuine classes.
- D. Synthetic a priori judgements are impossible because adding a predicate not contained in the subject always requires a fresh sensory warrant.

MCQ 41. Kant and Hegel on categories and reality

With reference to 2026 Q4(b), which comparison is most accurate?

- A. Kant and Hegel both treat the categories as an inherited fixed list whose validity ends at appearances, but Hegel adds a theological proof of the noumenal world.
- B. Kant makes categories empirical generalisations abstracted from experience, whereas Hegel alone regards thought as constitutive of experienced objectivity.
- C. Hegel rejects Kant's constitutive turn and restores a pre-critical model in which thought passively copies an independently ready-made reality.
- D. Kant retains fixed a priori categories and a thing-in-itself limit; Hegel makes categories dialectically self-developing determinations of reality and rejects that fixed boundary.

MCQ 42. From failed God-proofs to practical postulates

Which one of the following preserves the proper boundary between Kant's speculative critique and his practical sequel?

- A. Once speculative proofs fail, practical reason supplies theoretical knowledge of God through the moral law and thereby completes speculative theology.
- B. Speculative reason neither proves nor disproves God; practical reason postulates God for the highest good without converting rational belief into theoretical cognition.
- C. The practical postulate repairs the ontological proof by adding moral perfection to the concept of the most real being and deriving existence from it.
- D. Kant's critique excludes every rational role for God, so mentioning practical postulates contradicts the Dialectic and abandons critical limits.